

is not affected much and the server is not overloaded, or by automatically browsing a site and downloading content specified by the user. Most download managers integrate seamlessly with browsers, and have an easy-to-use interface. Clicking on a link in a browser automatically starts the download in the download manager. Download managers also have additional features, such as scheduling, traffic shaping, virus-checking, and cataloguing.

Download managers have evolved from being standalone bare-bone applications. Some downloaders are optimised for a certain function. For example, Offline Explorer is designed to download entire Web sites; Golzilla was one of the earliest to use adware for its interface. Also related to the download managers are peer-to-peer sharing applications such as KaZaa, Gnutella and BitTorrent. Increasingly, a lot of software companies and content providers are using downloaders to wield control over their software downloads, especially freeware.